OFFICIAL PROGRAM & RULES

THE INTERNATIONAL SPACE DOG SHOW

A Travelling Exhibition of Pets, Mascots, and Companion Creatures from Every Corner of Wildspace

Hosted this cycle at the Floating Pavilion, three days' sail coreward of the Rock of Bral.
All chartered crews, independent operators, and persons of quality welcome to enter.
Entrants need not be dogs. Entrants need not, strictly, be animals. The judges have seen worse.

What This Show Actually Is

Founded some eighty-odd years ago by the reclusive breeder and collector Ines Quorrel, who grew tired of watching the founding houses turn every gathering into a negotiating table and wanted one event where that was expressly, formally forbidden. The Astral Kennel Concordance has run the Show every cycle since, and the no-business rule still holds on the judging floor, by long tradition rather than any enforceable law, which has somehow made it stick harder than a law would have.

It has become, almost by accident, the one place in known space where rival houses, independent crews, and everyone between them stand shoulder to shoulder and mean it, if only for the length of a judging round. Attendance is itself a kind of status. Winning, even a minor category, follows a name for seasons.

This Cycle's Categories

Best Presentation — *sponsored by House Delverane*

Judged against the entrant's own kind, not another's: coat, scale, carapace, plumage, or whatever the species in question actually has. Condition, care, and demonstrated resilience to vacuum all count.

Most Convincing Trick — *sponsored by the Concordance*

A trick is convincing if the judges believe the animal meant to do it.

Best Costume — *sponsored by House Nightbreeze*

Judged on craft, concept, and the entrant's own evident tolerance for wearing it.

The Long Run — *sponsored by House Stoneward*

A timed obstacle course run in full gravity-plane conditions. Speed and composure both count.

The Proving Round — *sponsored by House Stoneward*

A supervised sparring trial between willing, evenly matched entrants, judged on skill and control. Ends at the first clean hit or clear dominance. No serious harm permitted, by order of the committee and the house physicians both.

Each entrant may be registered for up to three categories, no more.

Best in Show

Not a category of its own, Best in Show is chosen by the full judging panel from among this cycle's category champions. This cycle's purse is sponsored in full by Lord Wendell Carraway, of his own house's generosity and at considerable personal expense, a gesture the committee is given to understand he will mention unprompted at every opportunity between now and the judging.

Purse: 20,000 gp

Honorary, Not Judged

Longest Serving Ship's Animal

Presented, not competed for, to the entrant with the longest verifiable charter-service record. The committee asks only for the paperwork.

(continued: this cycle's judges, the Reigning Champion, and on-site services)

This Cycle's Judging Panel

Magistrate Yevelda Thorn

Presentation & honorary awards

A silver elf of considerable age and considerably more opinions, fixated on symmetry to the point of personal eccentricity. Known to disqualify an otherwise flawless entrant for one crooked whisker.

Commodore (Ret.) Ossian Vale

The Long Run & The Proving Round

A retired Stoneward patrol officer, blunt and unsentimental, respects raw competence over any amount of polish. The panel's hardest mark by a wide margin, and everyone knows it.

Madam Quill

Most Convincing Trick & Best Costume

A gnome barely taller than most of the entrants, easily delighted and impossible to win over twice with the same trick. Takes meticulous, illegible notes throughout every round.

The Reigning Champion

PARAGON

Void-Adapted Mastiff · Owner: Verity Gilt
Three-Time Consecutive Category Champion

"Proven bloodline. The grooming budget pays for itself. Every year somebody new thinks this is the year, and every year it simply isn't." V. Gilt, pre-judging remarks, cycle after cycle after cycle.

Official On-Site Services

Grooming, veterinary, and refreshment concessions are available dockside throughout the exhibition. The committee is pleased to announce this cycle's roster of on-site service vendors will be finalized and posted the morning of the first judging round.

Entry & Conduct, the Short Version

- Entry is open to any companion creature accompanied by a sponsoring crew, house, or individual of record.
- Entrants must be collected, non-hostile, and under control at all times, judges' own discretion applies.
- Sabotage, bribery, or interference with another entrant is grounds for immediate disqualification, should the committee ever actually catch anyone at it.
- The committee's judging decisions are final, binding, and occasionally inexplicable.

The International Space Dog Show thanks you for your continued, baffling enthusiasm.